reared itself in public discourse. Indeed within weeks of the release of Nelson Mandela, the Jewish community was jolted when he warmly embraced Yasser Arafat in Lusaka. The day after pictures of the meeting were published, Mandela was quoted as saying, in response to a question, that if his meeting with Arafat and his statements equating the struggle of the Palestinians with that of the blacks were to alienate "South Africa's influential Jewish community," that was "too bad."[34]

Hostility towards the Jewish state is bolstered by the English language press, owned by the Irishman, Tony O'Reilly's Independent Group from 1994 till last year, when the group was bought by an ANC-connected Muslim, Iqbal Surve. Under the Independent Group, a previously benign and often supportive view of Israel shifted to one of hostility. British pro-Palestinian journalists Robert Fisk and John Pilger were regular columnists, poisoning an already hostile atmosphere. Even 9/11 did not temper the tone. Some of the hostility was driven by Ronnie Kasrils, a South African Jewish Communist, member of the ANC underground for thirty years, and a senior commander of its military wing, *Umkhonto We Sizwe*. Until 2009 he served as a cabinet minister and consistently compared Israel with apartheid South Africa. Kasrils sees the Jews as having much in common with the Afrikaners, including the idea of "chosenness," which he contends is used to advance a particular ethnicity—"an exclusivity which gives rise to racism and all sorts of negative things."[35] Of course, as noted above, the notion of exclusivity—manifest in the ethno-national state—has always raised problems for the radical left. It challenges a deep seated universalism and a long-held hostility to nationalism.

In addition to these theoretical challenges, the success of South Africa's so-called "miracle" further undermines the exclusive Jewish state. Commentators increasingly saw the Israeli-Palestinian conflict through a South African prism and increasingly asked why Israelis and Palestinians could not follow the South African example and establish a single constitutional state. An exemplar of this reasoning has been the veteran journalist and former editor of the liberal *Rand Daily Mail*, Allister Sparks. In repeated articles he has drawn parallels between South Africa and Israel, arguing that the Jewish state has no alternative but to negotiate with its enemies, including Hamas and Islamic Jihad. Israel's refusal to do so, he maintains, is reminiscent of the old National Party in South Africa.[36] For Sparks the "two state" solution is dead. Israel's lack of will to remove the settlements coupled with demographic realities has precluded this option. "Like South Africa's bantustan policy," he writes, "it was a nice idea in theory to separate rival groups living in one country so that each can have its

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